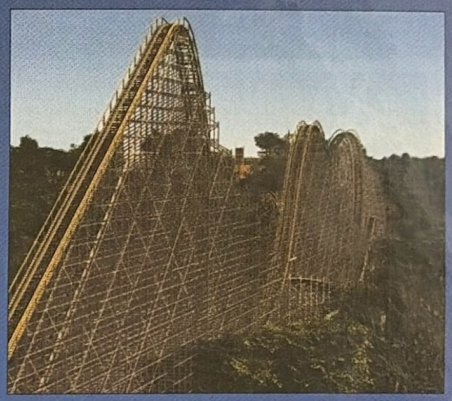
Weekend Warrior

YOU HAVE THREE DAYS AND COUNTING...

ROLLER COASTER ROUNDUP!

Amusement-park thrills that put the fear of God squarely in your underpants.

It's a bigger adrenaline rush than cutting yourself!



GOOD WOOD

BOULDER DASH LAKE COMPOUNCE, BRISTOL, CONNECTICUT
Nestled against a rugged mountainside, the Boulder Dash (it's not just a clever name) comes ridiculously close to rocks and trees as it blasts around its rickety track. Like most wooden coasters, this thing makes you feel like you're going to careen off the track at any moment and end up on a *Faces of Death* DVD. Thankfully, it's full of weightless airtime—the Tantric orgasm of coaster effects. lakecompounce.com

THE CYCLONE ASTROLAND AT CONEY ISLAND, BROOKLYN, NEW YORK
The Cyclone has more unexpected twists and turns than *Lost*. This vintage ride is so curvy that it inspired its own genre: "Cyclone-style" coasters coil into themselves (unlike the "out-and-back" variety, which make one giant loop). Tape your eyes open for this jarring ride to watch for "head-chopper" effects, and since there aren't any seat dividers, get ready to grind hips with the bony weirdo next to you. astroland.com

STEELING THE SHOW

KINGDA KA SIX FLAGS GREAT ADVENTURE, JACKSON, NEW JERSEY
As the tallest (456 feet) and fastest (128 mph) coaster on the planet, Kingda Ka is the scariest thing to come out of New Jersey since Joe Piscopo. Spine-compressing hydraulics blast riders vertically up a 45-story tower, whereupon they plummet helplessly into a 270-degree death spiral. After the 50-second ride, you'll spend the rest of the afternoon insisting that you accidentally sat on a fresh funnel cake. sixflags.com

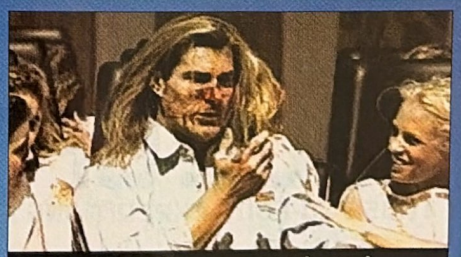
SUPERMAN RIDE OF STEEL SIX FLAGS NEW ENGLAND, SPRINGFIELD, MASSACHUSETTS
From the moment it leaves the station, Superman is all about speed. You'll hit 77 mph on the initial hill, but an underground tunnel at the bottom makes the 221-foot drop seem twice as long as it really is. You can also expect two giant helixes (banked turns that wrap around themselves like sideways loops) and enough g's to make Joan Rivers look 19 again. sixflags.com

READY TO ROLL IN '06

THE VOYAGE HOLIDAY WORLD, SANTA CLAUS, INDIANA
Wild-eyed adrenaline nerds who say they don't make wooden coasters like they used to are about to eat their words. It will take almost three minutes to lap these shivering timbers, and the initial 154-foot hill tops out at 66 degrees—the steepest for wooden tracks in the U.S. With five underground tunnels to boot, you'll be more disoriented than a toddler in the House of Mirrors when you stumble off. holidayworld.com

TATSU SIX FLAGS MAGIC MOUNTAIN, LOS ANGELES
A ride on the Tatsu coaster will be eerily similar to your first sexual experience—fast, out of control and in a headfirst "flying" position. This modern marvel will have plenty of bells and whistles, including a 124-foot "pretzel" loop, a 103-foot "flat spin," a 96-foot-tall "zero-G" roll and a 360-degree "inline roll" inversion. After this much flipping and diving, you'll wish you hadn't eaten that enormous turkey leg. sixflags.com

WHEN HILARITY ATTACKS



Luckily, his heaving pecs were unharmed.

Freak coaster accidents are only funny when they involve beefy blond himbos like Fabio. The golden-maned model was riding Apollo's Chariot at Busch Gardens in Williamsburg, Virginia, (and traveling at an estimated 73 mph no less) in March 1999 when a wayward bird slammed into his beautiful face, killing the would-be winged assassin and splattering blood all over his female copassengers. Thankfully, he wasn't seriously injured or posing for any romance novel covers that afternoon.